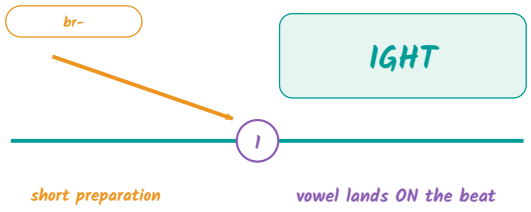
MODULE 04

Diction & Articulation

Make every word clear without unnecessary tension.





Consonant Launch Pad

One Word, Three Vowels

TEN ACTIVITIES IN THIS MODULE

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32 Final Consonant Appointment

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36 Syllable Train

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38 Diphthong Landing

39 Word Stress Compass

40 Text Relay Without Blur

Choose one goal. Try one illustrated task. Carry what works into your music.

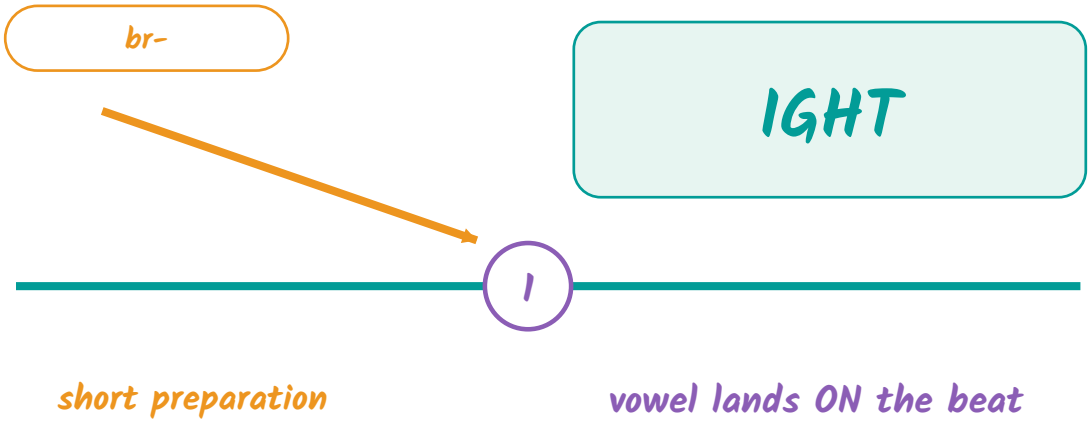
ACTIVITY 031

Consonant Launch Pad

Diction & Articulation

4 minutes / Text 'Bright morning, clear sky'.

Place an initial consonant just before the shared vowel.



The consonant prepares the word; the vowel meets the shared beat.

1. Speak the text on four beats, noticing the short consonant before each vowel.
2. Agree that the vowel lands on the beat; rehearse the opening word with a visible preparation.
3. Sing the whole line on one note, then in repertoire, keeping consonants concise rather than louder.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The first vowel arrives together while the word remains recognizable.

COMMON TRAP

Putting the consonant and vowel both after the beat.

MAKE IT WORK

Start with 'moon' and 'light' before using consonant clusters.

ACTIVITY 032

Final Consonant Appointment

Diction & Articulation

5 minutes / Words ending in t, k, or s.

Agree exactly when a final consonant will be heard.

	1	2	3	4
"light"	lah	ah	ah	t
"look"	loo	oo	oo	k
"peace"	pee	ee	ee	s

Hold the vowel through beat 3; agree one final-consonant event on beat 4.

1. Sing 'light' on a comfortable note for three beats and place its final 't' on beat four.
2. Repeat with 'look' and 'peace', keeping the vowel alive until the agreed release.
3. Mark the same decision in one real phrase and rehearse only its last two words.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

There is one clear consonant event rather than several scattered endings.

COMMON TRAP

Releasing the vowel before the agreed consonant.

MAKE IT WORK

Use one final consonant at a time and exaggerate timing in speech first.

ACTIVITY 033

Vowel-Only Text

Diction & Articulation

5 minutes / One familiar lyric line.

Reveal the vowel line hidden inside a lyric.

WORDS	Bright	morning	clear	sky
VOWELS	ai	or – i	ear	ai
WORDS	Bright	morning	clear	sky

A simplified teaching example: restore the words without losing the vowel line.

1. Speak the words naturally, then identify the main vowel in each syllable.
2. Sing the phrase using only those vowels, keeping its original rhythm and pitch.
3. Restore the consonants without breaking the connected vowel line; compare before and after.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The restored text remains as connected as the vowel-only version.

COMMON TRAP

Breaking the phrase when the consonants return.

MAKE IT WORK

Work with two words at a time and let the director model the vowels.

ACTIVITY 034

Slow-Speech Precision

Diction & Articulation

4 minutes / Sentence 'Many bright voices sing together'.

Clarify text without tightening the mouth or speeding up.

Ma-ny | bright | voi-ces | sing | to-ge-t her

Speak slowly | Clarify two words | Reconnect the sentence

Keep a conversational volume. Choose clarity rather than extra mouth effort.

1. Speak the sentence slowly at a comfortable conversational volume.
2. Choose the two least clear words and practise their syllables separately, using only necessary movement.
3. Speak the complete sentence in rhythm, then sing it once on a shared note.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Listeners can identify every word without the speaker increasing volume.

COMMON TRAP

Using extra volume to hide unclear speech.

MAKE IT WORK

Use a shorter sentence or show written words while speaking.

ACTIVITY 035

One Word, Three Vowels

Diction & Articulation

5 minutes / A word from current repertoire.

Agree a shared vowel shape for one problematic word.

LISTEN

Hear three relaxed versions

AGREE

Choose a version for this song

SING

Use it in the complete phrase

Listen respectfully; do not mock accents or guess an unfamiliar language.

1. Invite three relaxed spoken examples of the word; listen for differences in its vowel.
2. Choose the version that best fits the song's language and style without mocking accents.
3. Sing the word together at low volume and put it back into the phrase.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The ensemble agrees on a repeatable vowel while retaining understandable language.

COMMON TRAP

Judging accents instead of choosing a shared version.

MAKE IT WORK

Ask a fluent speaker or language coach when pronunciation is unfamiliar.

ACTIVITY 036

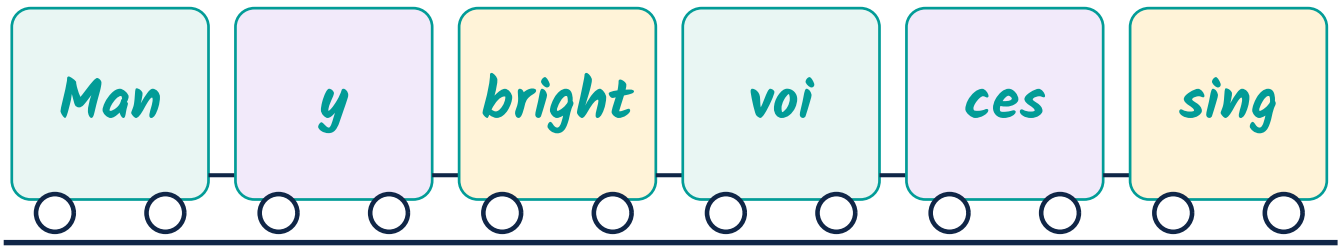
Syllable Train

Diction & Articulation

5 minutes / One line with six to ten syllables.

Align syllables in a quick text passage.

SYLLABLES / WORDS / PHRASE



Six syllable cars. Reconnect them into words before adding pitches.

1. Write a slash between syllables and speak each one over a slow steady pulse.
2. Group the syllables into meaningful words while keeping their places in the rhythm.
3. Add pitches only after the spoken sequence is reliable; increase speed in small steps.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

No syllable disappears when the music returns.

COMMON TRAP

Increasing speed while syllables still disappear.

MAKE IT WORK

Stay at the spoken stage or reduce the passage to its first four syllables.

ACTIVITY 037

Gentle Tongue Twister

Diction & Articulation

4 minutes / Text 'Red ribbon, blue ribbon'.

Practise flexible consonants without a speed contest.

Red	rib-bon
Blue	rib-bon

Original practice text. Alternate the two phrases over a steady pulse.

1. Speak the two phrases slowly with an easy jaw and clear word boundaries.
2. Alternate them on four beats, pausing for a normal breath after each pair.
3. Sing the words on 1-2-3-2-1, allowing one syllable to cover more than one note if needed.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Clarity survives without jaw tightening or racing.

COMMON TRAP

Turning clarity practice into a speed contest.

MAKE IT WORK

Use 'red, blue' alone and let singers choose a slower pace.

ACTIVITY 038

Diphthong Landing

Diction & Articulation

6 minutes / Word 'day' or another song word.

Coordinate a moving vowel in a sustained English word.

"day"

daa	aa	aa	y
1	2	3	4

Keep the main vowel through beats 1–3. Let the vowel ending arrive near beat 4.

1. Speak 'day' and notice that its vowel changes near the end.
2. Sing the first part of the vowel for three beats, moving gently to its ending on beat four.
3. Apply that timing to the actual phrase, then adjust it to the music's style and duration.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The vowel change happens together instead of early in some voices.

COMMON TRAP

Moving to the vowel ending too early.

MAKE IT WORK

Use a two-beat word and demonstrate before asking for a response.

ACTIVITY 039

Word Stress Compass

Diction & Articulation

5 minutes / A short unfamiliar text.

Make the natural stress of a lyric audible.

Lead toward the meaning



We sing **together** today

Keep the words around it clear

Keep the surrounding words clear; a meaningful word is not a shouted word.

1. Read the line as ordinary speech and circle its important syllables.
2. Speak it in the musical rhythm, keeping weak syllables clear but lighter.
3. Sing the line and compare whether listeners still hear its natural meaning.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The sung stress supports meaning rather than emphasizing every beat equally.

COMMON TRAP

Shouting the stressed word.

MAKE IT WORK

Clap the stressed syllables before adding all the words.

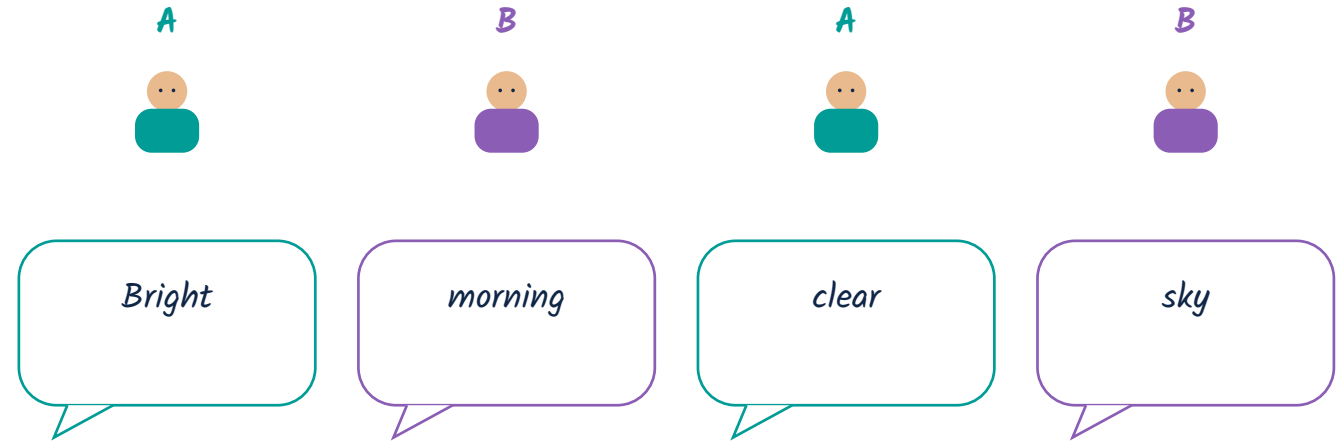
ACTIVITY 040

Text Relay Without Blur

Diction & Articulation

6 minutes / Four short text fragments.

Pass a lyric between groups while keeping words understandable.



Then restore the whole line together

Alternate words between A and B, then restore the line as one choir.

1. Assign one fragment to each group and let them speak it clearly at a moderate tempo.
2. Pass the fragments in order without speeding up or adding gaps between words.
3. Repeat on a shared pitch, then let everyone sing the complete line.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

A listener can write down the whole line accurately after the relay.

COMMON TRAP

Leaving gaps between the groups' words.

MAKE IT WORK

Use two groups and show the order on paper.